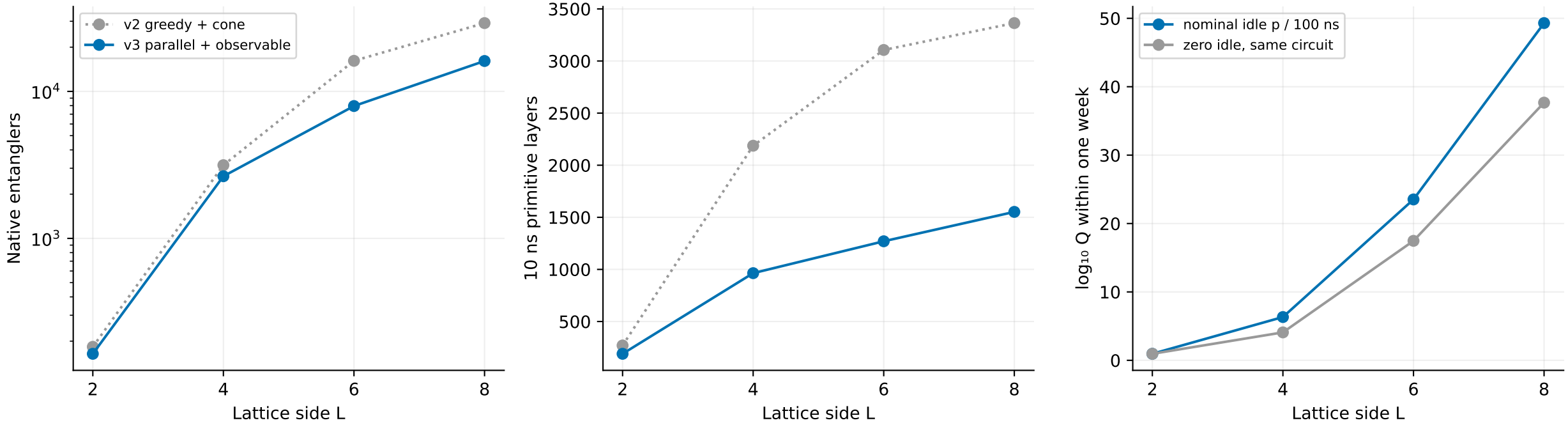

Plaquette τ = 1, r = 4; ε = 0.001. These costs remain conditional: r = 4 fails the small-patch Trotter checks.